



DR AJAY SWAROOP MATHUR
Chairman (Board of management),
Sir Ganga Ram Hospital



EMBARKING ON A BOLD MISSION OF CHANGE AND EXCELLENCE

It was a significant moment for SRGH when its eminent ENT surgeon, Dr Ajay Swaroop Mathur, was appointed as Chairman of the premier healthcare institution of the Country. Having seen the hospital grow in many ways for the last 38 years, he is keen to strike a balance between the hospital's value-based traditions and the new tech dominated environment, to steer SRGH to its next level of growth.

You are closely associated with SRGH since 1984. Could you share what makes SRGH a phenomenon in its league?

Sir Gangaram Hospital has consistently retained a reigning position in the world of healthcare in the country for many decades on the strength of its ingrained values, which are absolutely ethical practise, charity as its ethos, emphasis on teaching and focus on scientific research with cutting edge-technology. That absolutely sums up the hospital and therefore no drastic or dramatic changes are needed. As they say "you don't change a winning combination", but having said that resting on one's laurels impedes progress. We are aware of the changing milieu so the focus would now be on maintaining the basic ethos of the hospital, but change our outlook.

What efforts are you making to cope with a tech-driven media world?

Frankly speaking, publicity has never been a priority because we survived by word-of-mouth publicity, but with the digital media explosion, we have to accept

change and work towards adopting them. Also, today India is a young country where the older generation which remembers Gangaram, with reverence is fading out. Youngsters are totally dependent on Google search and ratings of a hospital to seek help, so if we don't innovate and don't move with the times, we will be soon lagging behind. That's my biggest challenge to start with. As far as my consultants, nurses, technicians, and rest of the staff are concerned, I am proud of their loyalty which is totally unflinching over the last 40 years, and it remains so because we are a big united family with a common mission to serve humankind with compassion.

Organ transplantation is developing as a specialty in itself. How is SRGH looking at it?

The time has come that organ transplantation by itself develops as a branch. So keeping that in mind it is planned to have one floor and two theatres totally dedicated to organ transplantation in the upcoming new block. We will then have a compact and composite transplantation team of diverse expertise to look into a gamut of things that is involved in the fledgling

specialty. Another significant achievement would be the inauguration of a dedicated cancer centre, which was missing in our portfolio, and hopefully in 2023, we shall be talking about oncology in a big way!

Standing at the threshold of 2023, do you envisage expansion plans in the near future?

Our quality medical care attracts a lot of traction that compelled us to acquire the City Hospital and Kolmet Hospital in the vicinity of the main SRGH premises. Unlike other healthcare brands, we have not leveraged our brand value to its optimum and did not branch out simply for the reason that we do not work on hard-core business model. SRGH is typically a no-frills conventional hospital focused only on treating people and so we are not aggressive as corporate driven hospitals. Nevertheless, SRGH's goodwill is such that we get many offers to start a semi philanthropic organization on our time-tested pattern, which is under the purview of the Trust of the Society, who are seriously looking at a few projects. We definitely would want to move atleast into the NCR region.